

James Sheldon

Senior full-stack engineer · Founding engineer & CTO

Calgary, AB · Remote

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SUMMARY

I'm a full-stack engineer with 20+ years of building web products, most recently as founding engineer and CTO at Cashew Research, where I built a generative AI platform for market research. I work across TypeScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, GraphQL, and PostgreSQL, and I'm as comfortable leading a team as I am shipping features myself. Before Cashew, I built search and discovery at Contra and led technical work for clients like Nissan at Critical Mass.

SKILLS

Front-end: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js

Back-end: Node.js, GraphQL, tRPC, Temporal

Data: PostgreSQL, Prisma, ZenStack, MongoDB, MSSQL, Meilisearch

Testing and delivery: Playwright, Cypress, Jest, Vitest, mutation testing, CI/CD, Terraform

AI-assisted development: Claude Code, agent-based workflows

Leadership: hiring, mentoring, architecture decisions, client and vendor consultation

EXPERIENCE

Cashew Research

2024 - 2026

Chief Technology Officer (Founding Engineer) · Remote (Calgary)

- + Built a generative AI platform for market research that generated targeted survey questions, analyzed research data, and turned results into actionable insights.
- + Designed a methodology selection engine that recommended research approaches based on a study's goals.
- + Built the platform on Next.js, tRPC, PostgreSQL, and Temporal in a monorepo.
- + Co-authored about 5,300 commits with Claude Code on a self-designed agent system, with mutation testing as the review bar.
- + Co-owned, approved, and operated the Terraform and CI; the platform engineer built most of it.
- + Led the engineering team and instituted biweekly 1:1s.

Contra

Apr 2021 - Jan 2024

Senior Fullstack Engineer · Remote

- + Designed and built the search and discovery feature at the core of Contra's talent discovery experience.
- + Led teams through projects central to the product across Search & Discovery and Jobs.
- + Turned product requirements into tested, well-structured code across the stack, often on tight deadlines.
- + Mentored teammates while working as both an individual contributor and team lead.

Critical Mass

Jan 2014 - Apr 2021

Tech Director, Tech Lead, Senior Developer · Calgary, AB

- + Set departmental practices and development standards with fellow tech directors and leads.
- + Hired, mentored, and staffed developers, and supported their career development at the department level.
- + Guided architecture decisions with project developers and leads, and ran technical consultations with clients and third-party vendors.
- + Delivered Nissan/Infiniti Next Gen Shopping Tools, the LodgeLink platform rebuild, Nissan Dealer Inventory, the Nissan mobile rebuild, and a series of campaign vehicle configurators.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

- + **Sajak & Farki** · Front-end Developer. Built JavaScript admin dashboards, social campaigns, and Facebook apps; helped set build, development, and QA standards.
- + **Valtech (formerly NLC)** · Developer. Built the front end of a SharePoint 2010 performance-indicator dashboard with an agile team across North America.
- + **Bryan Mills Iradesso** · Web Solutions Specialist. Managed developers and designers on corporate websites, intranets, and mobile apps; wrote RFP responses and requirements.
- + **ZGM Modern Marketing Partners** · Lead Web Developer. Led a small team and built a custom CMS on .NET 4 and ASP.NET MVC with Twitter, Facebook, Google Maps, OpenID, Chase, and Moneris integrations.
- + **Sprung Instant Structures** · Web Developer / Graphic Designer. Built a photo management system for international marketing staff and maintained the company website.

EDUCATION

Mount Royal University · Bachelor of Communications, Electronic Publishing; Certificate of Arts and Sciences

Recommendations: [linkedin.com/in/jamessheldon/details/recommendations](https://www.linkedin.com/in/jamessheldon/details/recommendations)